

Directory Sync - Azure Active Directory (AAD)

Last updated by | Erik Ralston | Sep 20, 2021 at 7:00 AM PDT

This guide is meant to outline the onboarding process for [Azure Active Directory \(AAD or AD\)](#) to enable organizations to manage users and groups on [Soundbite.AI](#) easily and efficiently. This means automatically syncing information such that you never have to worry about manually adding or removing individuals or creating and organizing groups.

This is written such that a non-technical audience might get an overview of the process, but also contains explicit instructions for a technical AAD Admin to execute on enabling the Soundbite Platform for their organization and gathering the necessary information to enable the sync process. Finally, it discusses the collaboration the [Soundbite Customer Support](#) might offer to ensure the success of your integration and good outcomes for your organization.

Overview

Here is an outline of the process for setting up directory sync:

1. Grant admin access for the Soundbite platform to connect to your AD tenant
2. Select and share your sync configuration
3. Run and verify the sync for the first time

Once this is in place, the sync process will run at midnight UTC every night, maintaining your active directory.

When selecting your sync configuration, there should be some high-level planning between the professional guiding the deployment of Soundbite across the organization and the technical resource that will extract the information from AAD. If you need help designing your integration, please reach out for advice any time.

Grant Admin Access

An Active Directory admin will have to visit the Microsoft app permissions page for our Soundbite Platform app. This is the only way to add the Soundbite Platform to your Active Directory while simultaneously granting it the "Read Directory Data" permission.

To visit the page, you must first construct the specific URL for your organization's Active Directory to grant access to the Soundbite Platform app. As of this writing, this must be done manually based on your organization's unique Active Directory Tenant ID. First, find your tenant ID in the [Active Directory Overview blade in the Azure Portal](#) and copy it:

 Microsoft Azure

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 **Soundbite Inc. | Overview** ...

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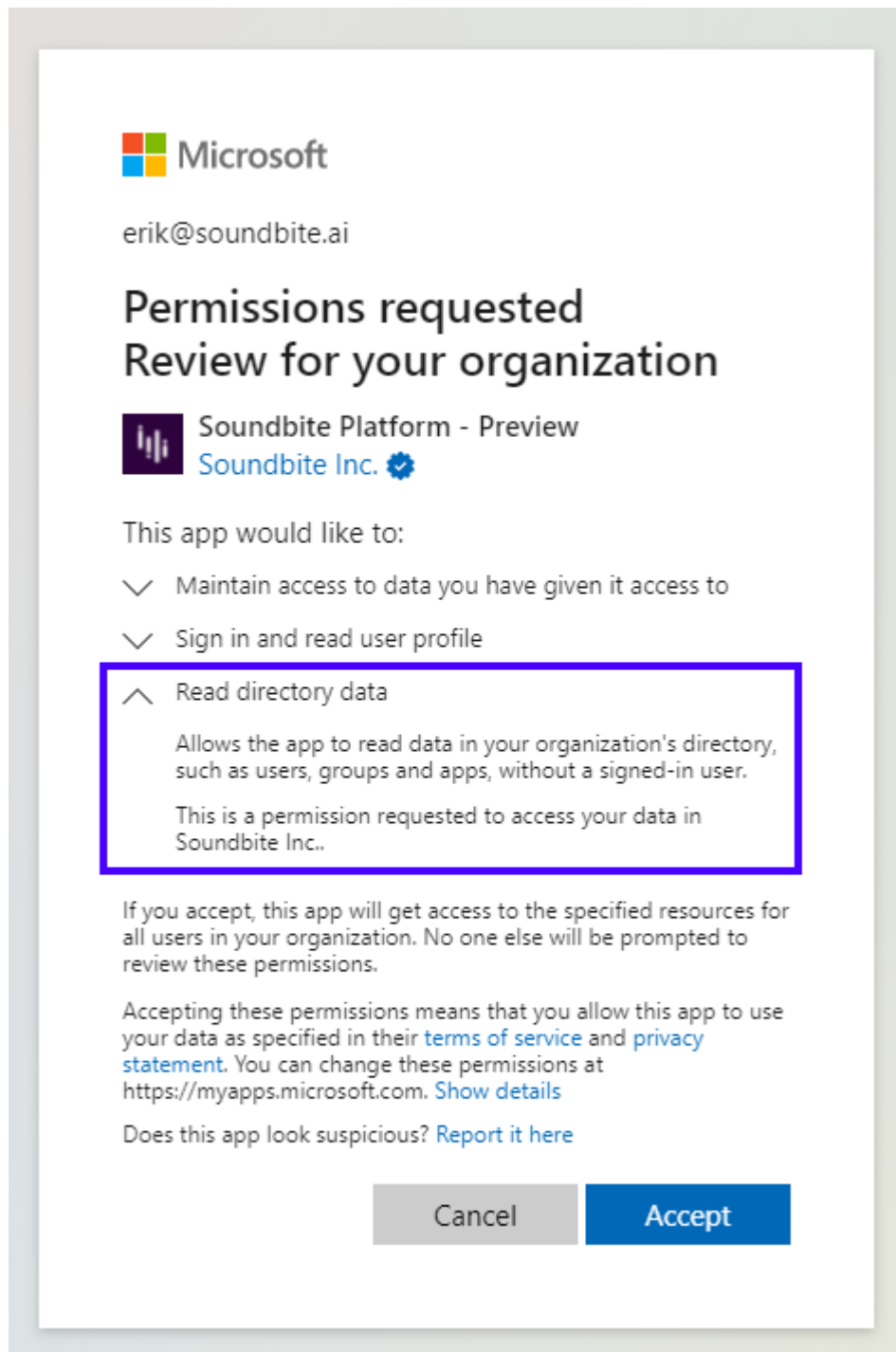
Basic information

Name	Soundbite Inc.
Tenant ID	e5f75632-637d-4d2e-a8a7-e8f6993acb74 
Primary domain	soundbite.ai
License	Azure AD Free

Then combine the Tenant ID with the given URL template below, based on the Soundbite Platform environment you wish to connect to your organization:

Environment	URL Template	Notes
Production	<code>https://login.microsoftonline.com/[ORGANIZATION_TENANT_ID]/adminconsent?client_id=e852716e-f657-42f1-b81b-f3c06d2b37c9</code>	Live environments for customers running pilot and production deployments
Sandbox	<code>https://login.microsoftonline.com/[ORGANIZATION_TENANT_ID]/adminconsent?client_id=34b24a2b-bc17-4014-a2b6-ba4d4c524848</code>	Development environemnt for previewing functionality and making custom integrations with Soundbite Platform

Where [ORGANIZATION TENANT ID] is the tenant ID you copied from the Azure Portal. The AD Admin should visit the link in their preferred browser, which will prompt the Microsoft Permissions request for the Soundbite Platform app relevant to your chosen environment:



Once accepted, this will redirect you back to the Soundbite app. It will think for a moment, then send you back to the home screen. If this does not allow access for some reason, reach out to our team and we will see if there is another path for adding permissions to access your tenant - including potentially using an Azure AD App Registration in your own tenant to bridge access in some unique cases.

This permission should only be granted with the express consent of your IT team. If you need help going through any approval or security review, consider reaching out to [Soundbite Customer Support](#). Keep in mind that Soundbite still allows individuals to interact with your Soundbite organization via invitation whether or not this grant is enabled; this simply accelerates user and group management by making it enterprise-wide.

Select and Share Your Sync Configuration

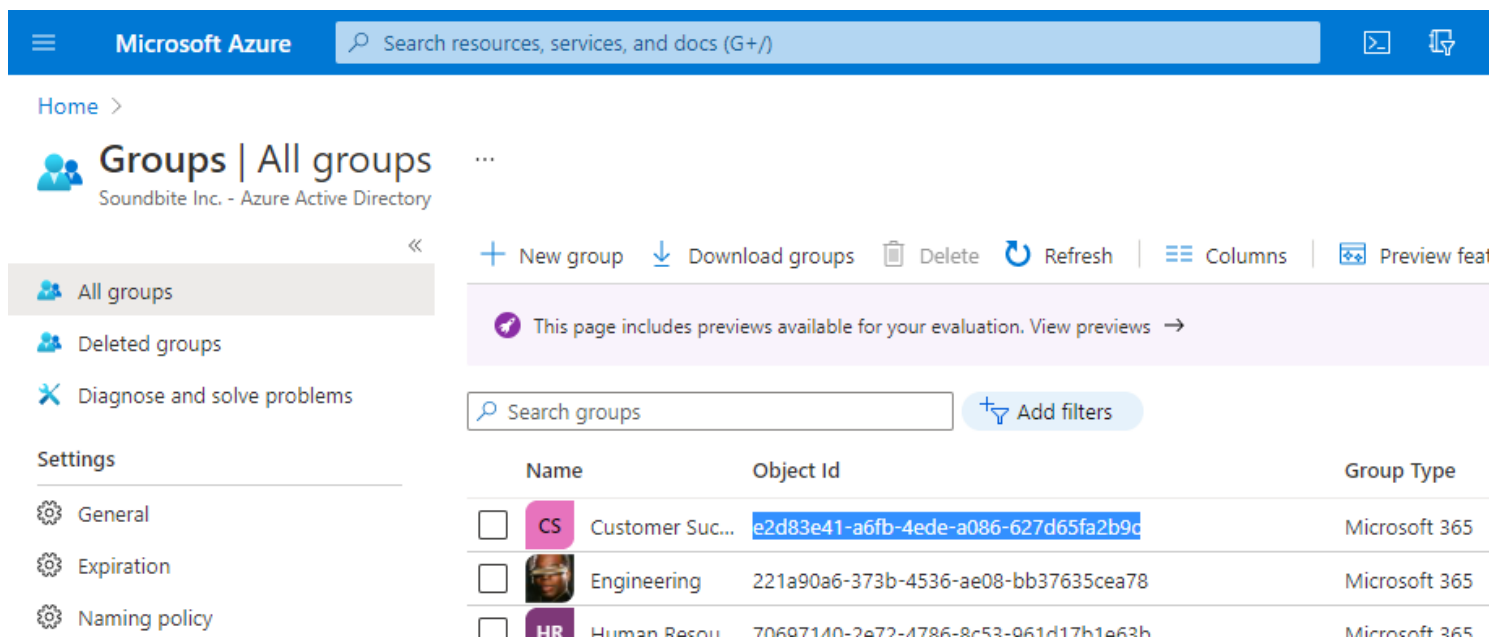
Soundbite has a few modes of operation when it comes to the users and groups that are synchronized. By selecting the best fit below, we can tailor the process to your needs. This likely requires gathering information from your Active Directory concerning unique identifiers for your users and groups. Keep in mind that these identifiers are not secret and are used behind the scenes for virtually all AD integrated applications.

To get started in most cases, **we recommend selecting a small number of groups in your organization and only synchronizing their members**. This can grow over time to a larger and larger set of groups. This relieves your team from manually adding and removing users and groups.

Keep in mind that only licensed Office 365 users can be synced at this time, no matter if you configure users or groups per below. If a user is ever disabled in Active Directory (EG, deleted from O365), but not removed from Soundbite due to the combination of settings below, they will still be locked out of the platform due to their O365 login being disabled.

Groups

In order to select a group for synchronization, we will need the AD group identifier. To find the AD Group Identifier (OID), you can look in the list of [all AD groups in your organization using the Azure Portal](#) . For the desired group, copy its Object Id (OID) from the interface like so:



The screenshot shows the Microsoft Azure portal interface for managing groups in an Azure Active Directory. The page title is 'Groups | All groups' for 'Soundbite Inc. - Azure Active Directory'. On the left, there is a sidebar with options: 'All groups', 'Deleted groups', 'Diagnose and solve problems', and 'Settings' (with sub-options: General, Expiration, Naming policy). The main area shows a table of groups with columns: Name, Object Id, and Group Type. The 'Object Id' column is highlighted for the 'Customer Suc...' group, showing the value 'e2d83e41-a6fb-4ede-a086-627d65fa2b9c'. Other groups listed include 'Engineering' and 'Human Resou...'. Above the table, there are buttons for 'New group', 'Download groups', 'Delete', 'Refresh', 'Columns', and 'Preview feat'. A search bar and 'Add filters' button are also present.

Name	Object Id	Group Type
☐ CS Customer Suc...	e2d83e41-a6fb-4ede-a086-627d65fa2b9c	Microsoft 365
☐ Engineering	221a90a6-373b-4536-ae08-bb37635cea78	Microsoft 365
☐ HR Human Resou...	70607140-2e72-4786-8c53-061d17b1e63h	Microsoft 365

By default, the group will be configured to add and update all of its members, creating users in Soundbite for them if they do not exist, and keeping all profile fields shadowed in Soundbite for each user in the group. Further configuration is possible if your organization has unique needs.

It is also possible to forego selecting an [allowlist](#)  of groups, it is possible to synchronize ALL groups for your organization. This only makes sense if your organization is small and you have very clean data in your Active Directory groups. Soundbite will ignore some groups that may cause clutter - such as the "All Company" group that exists by default in Office 365 - but it's challenging to cover all scenarios.

Users

If you choose to go with a list of groups and synchronizing their members - such as the recommended default - you do not need to specify a list of users and it will be determined automatically. However, if you want to

synchronize only a list of users or synchronize all users, Soundbite supports that as well.

To synchronize a list of users, you must provide a list of AD User Identifiers (OIDs) for each user you wish to add. This can be found in the list of [all AD users in your organization using the Azure Portal](#). For the desired user, open their profile and copy their Object Id (OID) from the interface in the field highlight below:

The screenshot shows the Microsoft Azure portal interface for the user profile of Erik Ralston. The top navigation bar includes the Microsoft Azure logo and a search bar. The breadcrumb trail is: Home > Soundbite Inc. > Users > Erik Ralston. The profile header shows the user's name, email (erik@soundbite.ai), and a profile picture. To the right of the profile picture is a 'User Sign-ins' chart showing activity from July 11 to July 2. Below the profile picture, the 'Creation time' is listed as 5/17/2020, 5:17:21 PM. The 'Identity' section contains a table with the following information:

Identity	
Name	Erik Ralston
First name	Erik
User Principal Name	erik@soundbite.ai
User type	Member
Object ID	b2be56fb-0b86-44c6-b0ab-8a... (highlighted in a blue box)
Issuer	sounbite.onmicrosoft.com

Below the 'Identity' section is a 'Job info' section with the following information:

Job info	
Job title	Co-Founder & Chief Technology Officer
Department	-- --

The left sidebar contains various management and activity options, including 'Diagnose and solve problems', 'Manage' (with sub-options like Profile, Assigned roles, Administrative units, Groups, Applications, Licenses, Devices, Azure role assignments, and Authentication methods), 'Activity' (with Sign-in logs and Audit logs), and 'Troubleshooting + Support' (with a New support request link).

Instead of synchronizing an allowlist of users, it is possible to synchronize ALL users for your organization. This makes sense if you wish to achieve enterprise-wide adoption of Soundbite and you believe that shadowing AD

groups is insufficient or undesirable for your needs. The [Soundbite Customer Support](#) team can guide you in this decision.

Share with Soundbite

After you have determined the sync settings you wish to use and shared the necessary list(s) of identifiers with the Soundbite team, e-mail them to [Soundbite Customer Support \(Support@Soundbite.AI\)](mailto:Support@Soundbite.AI) or your technical contact at Soundbite to request concierge onboarding of your settings.

Run and Verify

After applying your unique settings, a test run of your synchronization will be applied to your organization. Your contact at Soundbite will perform an initial verification once completed, then reach out to indicate its completion. There may be collaboration at this time if some identifiers are found to be inaccurate or permissions need to be further negotiated.

After customer acceptance of the synchronization, this process will run nightly at midnight UTC - causing no downtime for your organization. Keep in mind that manual management of users and groups in Soundbite is still possible in your tenant and you may find this a useful solution for inviting non-members of your organization to collaborate, along with expanding the possible scenarios for testing during a pilot period.

Next Steps

If you have any challenges, please reach out to [Soundbite Customer Support](#). We want to hear from you on the ease of the process and these instructions. We believe this is a great first step for easy adoption and management of Soundbite so your people can start talking to each other anywhere and anywhen. Thank you for taking this step in the journey and we look forward to going forward together.